

The best Indian dotcoms

Dying dotcoms, flagging e-commerce sites—they're all around us. So does the Internet still make a difference? Or have people given up hope in the Internet as a medium that can make our life easier, enabling us to take care of tasks that used to be expensive and time-consuming? Wrong! If you look beyond the R.I.P signs in the dotcom graveyard and the 'not-so-sunny' outlook for anything online, you'll realize that the Internet is growing and maturing. People in India and across the globe are using the Internet more than ever, not just for information and communication, but also for education and entertainment. This is corroborated by numerous Internet surveys conducted by firms such as Gartner and IDC, as well as by online polls conducted by us for the Popular Choice Awards, which saw an unprecedented number of Internet users voting for their favourite sites.

What are Web Awards 2001?

The Digit Web Awards 2001 confer honours on the most popular Indian Web sites—those sites which have kept their promise of delivering quality to the audience—from fields as wide as information, aesthetics and usability to services like shopping, education and travel. Digit Web Awards 2001 acknowledge these achievements, tell what's really good in the various sites, and try to bring the masses closer to the Internet.

The Digit Web Awards 2001 have nominations in 12 categories: Health, Entertainment,

Shopping & Auction, Sports, E-learning & Education, Search Engines, Information & portals, Communication & Mail, Jobs & Careers, Travel, News & Analysis, and Banking & Finance.

These sites have been picked by our editorial team from the plethora of popular Indian sites keeping in mind parameters like content, aesthetics and usability. 'Made in India' is the most important criteria to make it to this space; hence the absence of Indian versions of prominent International Web sites like msn.co.in or monster.co.in.

The judging process

The final judging process to select the winners of the Digit Web Awards involved the examination and evaluation of all the nominated sites—a total of five in each of the categories—across parameters like Quality of Content, Ease of Navigation, Aesthetics and Design. The judges were in-house and selected by the Digit editorial panel.

Popular Choice Awards

Almost 10,000 Internet users voted for their favourite Web sites during the course of our online polls for the Digit Popular Choice Awards. The voting, which took place over a period of 15 days beginning from the 1st of October 2001, saw close to 10,000 people vote. While some categories like Information & Portals and Jobs & Careers witnessed really close battles, others like Communication & Mail and Sports had the popular sites winning by a considerable margin.

